journalist or publisher,' he wrote; 'rather he is an enemy combatant – and should be treated as such.' If there could be any doubt as to Kuhner's meaning he dispelled it in his concluding sentence: 'We should treat Mr Assange the same way as other high-value terrorist targets: Kill him.'

I suppose I should have been shocked to find myself subjected to this sort of rhetoric from a fellow journalist, but I had learned long before that too many journalists are nothing more than stenographers for the powerful. Why should I be surprised to read that Jeffrey Kuhner wanted me dead when I had already been called 'an anti-American operative with blood on his hands' by the TV star and governor-impersonator Sarah Palin? And if the Attorney General Eric Holder thought I was 'an enemy of the US', why be shocked to read that the Fox News neocon Charles Krauthammer wanted me looking over my shoulder every time I walked down the street? Former Bush advisor Jack Goldsmith may have thought he was praising the US media when he said that their 'patriotism' made it easy for the government to work with them, but if I ever received such a 'compliment' I think I would resign.

On my way from exercise yard to cell, or from library to cell, I found my fellow inmates staring at me. The authorities were paranoid about the possibility of a prisoner taking a picture on his mobile phone. They're not supposed to have mobiles, but many do, and it seemed likely that a picture would end up in one of the newspapers. So the Governor appointed a guard who accompanied me everywhere. 'They think everyone is out to get me,' I said to him.

'Who?'

'The authorities.'

'Well,' he said, 'everyone has a price and these people have nothing.'

I met with a Catholic chaplain in one of the meeting rooms. There wasn't much in the way of spiritual guidance, not that I'm the perfect candidate, but the man was from Uganda and I felt a connection and we laughed as we talked. On the way back through the hallway I spotted Solzhenitsyn's *Cancer Ward* on a bookshelf. I took it back to my cell and got lost in it, just the old wisdom about inhumanity and the solace of the gracious book. An educated, middle-class woman appears in the story; her husband is in a labour camp and she wonders what she should tell their son. '"The truth's enough to sink a grown man, isn't it?" she says. "It's enough to break your